Daniel Thagard

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Engineering executive who scaled Corellium's R&D organization from Series A to a ~$200M acquisition — growing to 30+ engineers, passing SOC2, and cutting cycle time from over a month to under two weeks. Earlier founded a 70-person organization at Magic Leap and tripled engineering headcount at Immertec. Still hands-on across Go, AWS/GCP, Terraform, and applied AI (Amazon Bedrock, LLMs, GANs).

I build teams that ship — ask me about the hackathons.

Selected Highlights

- **~$200M exit at Corellium** — directed R&D from Series A through acquisition, scaling to 30+ engineers and establishing the operational rigor to pass a SOC2 audit.
- **Founded a 70-person organization at Magic Leap** — built a global Site Reliability & Core Engineering org spanning infrastructure, observability, chaos engineering, and developer productivity.
- **Mixed Reality cloud architecture** — architected and led an AR/MR application visualizing live cloud infrastructure, presented at Google Cloud Next '19.

Speaking & Writing

- **Magic Leap + GCP: Mixed Reality Architecture** — Google Cloud Next '19 (video)
- **Understanding Terraform and Corellium: A Perfect Match for Virtual Device Management** — Corellium Engineering Blog, Dec 2023 (article)

Experience

Corellium (*Delray Beach, FL*)

- Vice President, Engineering — Jun 2022–Present

- Recruited by a Corellium investor to build the engineering organization post–Series A; directed its growth and performance through to a ~$200M acquisition.
- Scaled to 30+ engineers across multiple platforms and disciplines, formalizing the engineering processes that enabled the company to pass a SOC2 audit.
- Reorganized development into cross-disciplinary squads aligned to business priorities, introduced a Scrum framework, and reduced cycle time from more than a month to less than two weeks.
- Championed platform and process improvements — feature flagging, automated testing, and semantic versioning — increasing velocity and release confidence; authored the published Terraform integration guide above.
- Partnered with Product and business stakeholders to define requirements, development workflows, and test/UAT practices for critical product launches.
- Strengthened team cohesion and visibility through company hackathons, gaming tournaments, and monthly demos showcasing new features.

Namely (*New York City, NY*)

- Staff Software Engineer, Platform — 2021–2022
- Recruited directly by the SVP of Engineering (reporting to the SVP, not the engineering directors) to solve delivery problems across organization.
- Stood up a tiger team of senior developers driving operational improvements across the platform.

Blackstone (*New York City, NY*)

- Vice President, Platform Engineering — 2021
- Managed a team of five developers across three SaaS products; recruited away by Namely's SVP of Engineering for a new challenge.

Immertec (*Tampa, FL*)

- Vice President, Engineering — 2020–2021
- Established foundational SDLC processes and partnered with leadership to complete a SOC2 audit.
- Scaled the engineering organization, tripling headcount and adding key platform, product, and QA capabilities.
- Introduced Kanban across multi-platform product lines (web, mobile, VR, AWS/GCP systems), implemented performance metrics and reporting, and built a weekly executive dashboard to surface health indicators.
- Built a comprehensive internal documentation library spanning onboarding, operational runbooks, product guides, and how-tos.
- Consolidated source control from GitHub and Bitbucket into SOC2-compliant GitLab, reducing costs and simplifying developer workflows.
- Implemented behavior-driven development (BDD) with CucumberStudio and BrowserStack, decreasing regressions and improving quality and velocity.

- Deployed CI/CD pipelines using GitLab Runners on Kubernetes with Terraform, automating delivery across development, staging, and production.
- *(Role eliminated in a company-wide downsizing; recruited into the VP role at Blackstone.)*

Magic Leap (*Dania Beach/Plantation, FL*)

- Senior Director, Site Reliability & Core Engineering — Feb 2016–Sep 2020 (progressed from Senior SRE → Manager → Senior Manager → Director → Senior Director)
- Founded a global organization of 70 engineers focused on technology infrastructure and developer productivity.
- Established competencies in end-user support, infrastructure engineering, observability, chaos engineering, and application delivery.
- Introduced Kanban project management, reducing average lead times from 45 days to 14 days.
- Automated the deployment of physical and virtual infrastructure, eliminating many bespoke manual processes.

Citrix (*Coconut Creek, FL*)

- DevOps Engineer — Jun 2015–Jul 2016

QQ Solutions, Inc (*Deerfield Beach, FL*)

- DevOps Team Lead — Jun 2014–Jun 2015
- Software Engineer — Jan 2014–Jun 2014

EPIS, LLC (*Stuart, FL*)

- Senior Software Developer — Sep 2011–Dec 2013

BenTek (*Palm Beach Gardens, FL*)

- Chief Information Officer — Sep 2010–Sep 2011
- Information Technology Director — Mar 2007–Sep 2010
- Information Technology Manager — Jun 2006–Mar 2007

Florida State University (*Tallahassee, FL*)

- Online Programs & Technology Training Manager — Aug 2004–Jun 2006
- Systems Administrator — Mar 2001–Aug 2004

Selected Technical Highlight

Mixed Reality Architecture (Magic Leap)

- Architected and led development of an application visualizing live cloud infrastructure via Spatial Computing (AR/MR) on the Magic Leap One

— using Unity, C#, Go, Terraform, Cloud Storage, and Cloud Functions to render Terraform state as a real-time directed graph, with image keys synchronizing shared multi-user experiences.
- Presented as **Magic Leap + GCP: Mixed Reality Architecture** at Google Cloud Next '19.

Core Technologies

Deep expertise: AI/ML · Terraform / IaC · AWS

- **AI/ML:** LLMs, GANs, deep learning, RAG, fine-tuning, prompt engineering, Amazon Bedrock, Bedrock Guardrails, Bedrock Knowledge Base, SageMaker
- **Cloud:** AWS, GCP, Azure
- **Platform/Infrastructure:** Kubernetes, Terraform, Docker, Istio, Knative, Vault, Ansible
- **CI/CD & Delivery:** GitHub Actions, GitLab / GitLab Runners, Jenkins, Vercel, feature flagging, semantic versioning, monorepo
- **Observability & Ops:** Datadog, Sentry, PagerDuty/Opsgenie
- **Data:** PostgreSQL, MySQL, DynamoDB
- **Languages & Scripting:** Go, Python, C#, JavaScript/Node, Bash/Zsh, SQL

Education

Degrees

- University of Florida, Masters of Business Administration
- Barry University, BS, Information Technology
  - Graduated Summa Cum Laude, 3.975 GPA

Certifications

- MIT xPro Designing and Building AI Products and Services, Jun 2026 (183976256)
- AWS Certified AI Practitioner, Mar 2026 (AWS05837963)
- Certified ScrumMaster (CSM), Jan 2024 (001610775)
- AWS Certified SysOps Administrator – Associate, Nov 2016 (AWS-ASOA-5456)
- AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate, Aug 2016 (AWS-ASA-19742)

- Earlier: MCSA, CCNA, CompTIA A+

Course Work

- Kanban System Design (KMP I)
- PMP Certification Training
- Kubernetes Certified Administrator

Awards

- **Exemplary Assignment: Designing and Building AI Products and Services** (*June 2026, Emeritus*)
  - Applied GAN technology to address societal challenges by evaluating sustainability and feasibility in AI product design.
- **Core Excellence of the Year 2024** (*February 2025, Corellium*)
  - Among the highest honors at Corellium, recognizing exceptional performance, leadership, and commitment to the company's goals and values.
- **Super Leaper** (*December 2017, Magic Leap*)
  - Nominated by colleagues for representing the company value of "together with love".